

Product Requirements Document

Complete specification of features, user stories, acceptance criteria, and success metrics for the Talent Thread platform — v1.0

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01

Executive Summary

Vision, mission, opportunity, elevator pitch

1.1 Vision

To be the most trusted platform where design talent grows, gets discovered, and gets paid — powered by AI that understands the craft.

1.2 Mission

Talent Thread connects India's best graphic and UX/UI designers with clients who need quality creative work, while using AI to continuously raise the skill ceiling of every designer on the platform.

1.3 The Opportunity

Metric	Data Point
India freelance market size	Rs 1.2 lakh crore+ and growing at 22% YoY
Designers in India (estimated)	2.5 million+ graphic and UX designers
Pain with Fiverr/Upwork	No design-specific intelligence, race-to-the-bottom pricing
AI in creative tools adoption	73% of designers report wanting AI career guidance
Target TAM (addressable)	~800,000 professional designers actively freelancing in India
Seed raise target	Rs 1.5–2 Crore
Valuation range (DCF)	Rs 9–15 Crore

1.4 What Makes It Different

Platform	Who It Serves	AI Features	Design Niche
Fiverr	Everyone	None	No
Upwork	Everyone	Basic matching	No
99designs	Designers only	None	Partial
Dribbble Hiring	Designers only	None	Yes (passive)
Talent Thread	Designers + Clients	Portfolio analysis, skill roadmap, AI matching	Yes (deep)

02

Problem Statement

Pain points, existing gaps, and why now

2.1 Designer Problems

No feedback on portfolio quality

Designers don't know what is wrong with their portfolio or why they are not getting hired. There is no structured, objective analysis available — only subjective peer feedback.

Race-to-the-bottom pricing

Generalist platforms incentivise undercutting. Experienced designers compete against cheap offshore labour because skills are invisible and undifferentiated.

No career growth intelligence

Freelancing platforms show jobs — they don't show designers what skills to learn next, what they're missing for higher-value work, or how to position themselves.

Discovery is broken

Designer profiles look identical on Fiverr and Upwork. Portfolio depth and design thinking are invisible — clients judge by reviews and price, not craft quality.

Inconsistent, unreliable payments

Delayed payments, payment disputes, and no formal escrow create cash flow anxiety for freelance designers working on project-based engagements.

2.2 Client Problems

Can't evaluate design quality quickly

Clients are not always designers. On generalist platforms it's hard to tell a good portfolio from a polished-but-shallow one without design expertise.

High drop-off rate in projects

Poor brief-to-delivery workflows on general platforms lead to revision loops, missed deadlines, and abandoned projects.

No trust mechanism for quality

Star ratings on Fiverr and Upwork are gameable. There is no objective quality signal.

Mismatched skills for the job

Clients searching for 'UI designer' get results ranging from PowerPoint specialists to senior product designers — no meaningful differentiation.

2.3 Why Now

- Claude API (Anthropic) makes high-quality vision-based portfolio analysis commercially viable at scale
- India's creator economy and freelance design market are growing at 22%+ YoY
- Post-COVID normalisation of remote design work has expanded client appetite for freelance talent
- Designers increasingly want platforms that help them grow, not just find gigs

- No Indian-first design-specific marketplace exists — the space is completely uncontested locally

03

Goals & Success Metrics

Business goals, KPIs, OKRs, launch targets

3.1 OKRs — First 12 Months Post-Launch

OKR 1 — Establish Platform Liquidity

- KR1: 500 verified designer profiles live within 90 days of launch
- KR2: 100 active client accounts within 90 days of launch
- KR3: 50 completed contracts within first 6 months
- KR4: Average time from job post to first application under 4 hours

OKR 2 — Validate AI Differentiation

- KR1: 80% of designers complete at least one AI portfolio analysis within first week of signup
- KR2: 70% of analysed designers report the report was useful or very useful (NPS survey)
- KR3: Designers who use AI features have 2x higher client hire rate than those who don't
- KR4: 40% of designers re-analyse portfolio within 60 days (improvement validation)

OKR 3 — Revenue & Unit Economics

- KR1: Rs 5 lakh GMV within 6 months of launch
- KR2: Rs 50,000 monthly recurring revenue from designer subscriptions by month 6
- KR3: Platform commission generating Rs 50,000+ per month by month 8
- KR4: Customer Acquisition Cost under Rs 500 per designer, Rs 2,000 per client

3.2 Key Performance Indicators

KPI	Definition	Month 6 Target	Month 12 Target
MAU (Designers)	Monthly active designers	300	1,000
MAU (Clients)	Monthly active clients	80	300
GMV	Total value of completed contracts	Rs 5L	Rs 25L
Take Rate	Platform commission as % of GMV	10%	10%
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue (subscriptions)	Rs 50K	Rs 2L
Activation Rate	% of signups completing onboarding	>70%	>80%
AI Usage Rate	% of designers who run portfolio analysis	>75%	>85%
Contract Completion Rate	% of started contracts reaching completed	>75%	>85%
Avg Contract Value	Average GMV per completed contract	Rs 8,000	Rs 15,000

NPS (Designer)	Net Promoter Score	>40	>55
NPS (Client)	Net Promoter Score	>35	>50
Churn Rate (Pro)	Monthly churn on designer Pro subscription	<8%	<5%
Dispute Rate	% of contracts that raise a dispute	<3%	<2%
Time to First Hire	Days from client signup to first contract	<14 days	<7 days

04

User Personas

Designer personas, client personas, behavioural archetypes

4.1 Designer Personas

P-D1 — The Emerging Designer

Age Range	22–26
Experience	0–3 years
Tools	Figma, Canva, Illustrator
Goals	Land first freelance clients, build portfolio, understand what clients want
Pain Points	No idea why they aren't getting hired. Portfolio exists but no feedback. Competing with seniors on the same platform with no differentiation.
Motivation	AI tells them exactly what to fix. Gets confidence and direction.
Platform Behaviour	Checks platform daily. Applies to many jobs. Heavily uses AI features.

P-D2 — The Mid-Level Professional

Age Range	26–32
Experience	3–6 years
Tools	Figma, Adobe Suite, After Effects
Goals	Raise hourly rate, attract premium clients, specialise in a niche
Pain Points	Stuck at Rs 500–800/hr. Knows their work is good but can't prove it to clients. Tired of Upwork's race-to-bottom dynamic.
Motivation	AI validates their strengths and shows the exact skill gap to Rs 2,000/hr.
Platform Behaviour	Selective about applications. Prefers direct-invite model. Values premium positioning.

P-D3 — The Senior Creative

Age Range	30–40
Experience	6–12 years
Tools	Full Adobe Suite, Figma, Webflow
Goals	High-value long-term retainers, less time on proposals, reputation building
Pain Points	Too much time filtering poor-fit opportunities. Clients undervalue senior work.
Motivation	Platform surfaces them to quality clients. AI score validates premium positioning.

Platform Behaviour	Infrequent but deliberate. Wants inbound. Pro subscription for visibility boost.
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4.2 Client Personas

P-C1 — The Startup Founder

Company Size	2–15 person team
Budget Range	Rs 10,000–50,000 per project
Design Needs	Brand identity, pitch deck design, landing page, product UI
Pain Points	Can't afford a full-time designer. Wastes hours evaluating bad portfolios on Fiverr.
Motivation	AI-scored designers — knows upfront who's worth looking at. Brief-to-delivery workflow built in.
Platform Behaviour	Posts 2–4 jobs/month. Wants speed. Hires within 48 hours. Repeat buyer once trust established.

P-C2 — The D2C Brand Manager

Company Size	20–100 person company
Budget Range	Rs 30,000–2,00,000 per engagement
Design Needs	Social media design, packaging, campaign creatives, video editing
Pain Points	Inconsistent quality from freelancers found on Instagram DMs. No formal process.
Motivation	Structured contracts, milestones, escrow payments. Quality-vetted designers.
Platform Behaviour	Long-term retainer preferred. Posts jobs less frequently but higher value. Pays on time.

P-C3 — The Agency Overflow Client

Company Size	Design or marketing agency
Budget Range	Rs 15,000–1,00,000 per project
Design Needs	Overflow work during peak periods — UI screens, social assets, illustration
Pain Points	Managing contractors outside a platform is messy. Invoices, contracts, NDAs — all manual.
Motivation	Platform-native contracts, invoicing, and payments. Fast turnaround from vetted talent.
Platform Behaviour	High frequency, medium value per project. Wants fast application-to-hire cycle.

05

User Stories & Acceptance Criteria

Exhaustive story map for all user roles

Priority Legend: P0 = Must-Have (Launch Blocker) | P1 = High | P2 = Medium | P3 = Backlog

5.1 Authentication & Onboarding

US-001	Register as Designer or Client	P0
As a	new user	
I want to	register with email and password and choose my role (Designer or Client)	
So that	I can access the right onboarding experience for my role	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Email and password fields with validation (min 8 chars, 1 special char) ✓ Role selection screen appears after signup — Designer or Client ✓ Email verification sent immediately after signup ✓ User cannot access dashboard until email is verified ✓ Error message shown if email already exists	

US-002	Complete Designer Onboarding	P0
As a	new designer	
I want to	complete my profile with skills, tools, experience, and portfolio links	
So that	clients can understand my expertise and I can start receiving AI analysis	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Onboarding has 4 steps: Basic Info, Skills and Tools, Portfolio Links, Summary ✓ Full name, tagline, location, avatar upload required ✓ Skill multi-select from pre-seeded tag list (minimum 1 required) ✓ Tool multi-select (minimum 1 required) ✓ Progress saved on each step — can resume if user closes browser ✓ On completion, redirect to dashboard with Analyse Your Portfolio CTA	

US-003	Complete Client Onboarding	P0
As a	new client	
I want to	complete my company profile and project preferences	
So that	designers can see who I am and I can start posting jobs	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Name, company name, industry, and website fields ✓ Company logo upload (optional but prompted) ✓ Typical budget range selection ✓ Design categories needed (multi-select) ✓ On completion, redirect to client dashboard with Post Your First Job CTA	

US-004 Log In and Manage Session		P0
As a	returning user	
I want to	log in with my credentials and stay logged in across sessions	
So that	I do not have to re-authenticate every visit	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Email and password login with show/hide password toggle ✓ Remember Me option keeps session for 30 days ✓ Forgot Password flow: email link, reset form, confirmation ✓ Logout clears session and redirects to /login ✓ Incorrect credentials show generic Invalid email or password message	

5.2 Designer Features

US-010 Browse and Search Jobs		P0
As a	designer	
I want to	browse open job listings and filter by category, budget, and experience level	
So that	I can find projects that match my skills and desired rate	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Marketplace page loads within 2 seconds with at least 20 jobs per page ✓ Search bar filters by job title and description (full-text) ✓ Filters: category, budget range, experience level, project duration, job type ✓ Each job card shows: title, client name and logo, budget range, category tag, time posted ✓ Jobs sorted by newest first by default; option to sort by relevance ✓ Saved/bookmarked jobs appear in a separate tab	

US-011 View Job Details and Apply		P0
As a	designer	
I want to	view full job details and submit a proposal with my rate and cover letter	
So that	I can present my best case for why I am the right fit	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Job detail page shows: full description, required skills, budget, duration, deadline, attachments ✓ Apply button opens proposal form as a slide-over panel ✓ Proposal fields: cover letter (min 100 chars, max 1500), proposed rate, estimated timeline ✓ Submitted proposals appear in My Applications with status ✓ Cannot apply to same job twice — button replaced with Applied badge ✓ Application count on job card increments immediately on submission	

US-012	Manage Designer Profile and Portfolio	P1
As a	designer	
I want to	edit my public profile, update my skills, and manage my portfolio items	
So that	my profile always reflects my current capabilities and best work	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Profile edit form: tagline, bio, skills, tools, hourly rate, availability, links ✓ Portfolio section: add/remove/reorder portfolio items ✓ Each portfolio item: title, description, images (up to 8), category tag, tools used ✓ Availability status badge: Available, Partially Available, or Not Taking Work ✓ Profile completeness indicator (%) visible to designer — higher means better ranking ✓ Public profile URL: /designers/[username]	
US-013	View Application Status and History	P0
As a	designer	
I want to	track the status of all my job applications in one place	
So that	I know which opportunities are still active and which have been filled	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ My Applications dashboard shows all submissions with status badges ✓ Statuses: Under Review, Shortlisted, Hired, Rejected, Withdrawn ✓ Clicking an application shows the full job plus my submitted proposal ✓ Notification triggered when status changes ✓ Can withdraw application if status is Under Review (not after shortlisted)	
US-014	Manage Active Contracts	P0
As a	designer	
I want to	view all active contracts, access project details, and communicate with clients	
So that	I can manage my work, deliver milestones, and get paid on time	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Contracts dashboard shows: client name, project title, total value, milestones, status ✓ Contract detail shows all milestones with amounts, due dates, and status ✓ Each milestone has a Submit Deliverables button when status is funded ✓ File upload for deliverables (up to 5 files, max 50MB each) ✓ Built-in chat thread scoped to each contract with real-time messaging ✓ Notification when client approves milestone and payment is released	

5.3 Client Features

US-020	Post a Job	P0
As a	client	
I want to	post a detailed job listing describing my project requirements	
So that	qualified designers can find and apply for my project	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Job form fields: title, description, category, required skills, budget type and range ✓ Duration options: less than 1 week, 1–4 weeks, 1–3 months, 3–6 months, ongoing ✓ Experience level: Junior, Mid-Level, or Senior ✓ Attachment upload: up to 5 files (brief, mood board, reference) max 20MB each ✓ Preview mode before publishing ✓ Job goes live immediately on publish ✓ Client receives email confirmation with job link	
US-021	Review Applications and Hire a Designer	P0
As a	client	
I want to	view all applications for my job and select the best candidate	
So that	I can make a confident hiring decision based on proposal quality and portfolio	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Applications list sorted by AI score (highest first) by default ✓ Each application card shows: designer name, AI score badge, cover letter excerpt, proposed rate ✓ Full application view: complete cover letter, designer portfolio, profile, past reviews ✓ Shortlist toggle to mark top candidates ✓ Hire button on any application triggers contract creation flow ✓ All non-hired applicants receive automated rejection email when job is filled	
US-022	Manage Contract and Milestones	P0
As a	client	
I want to	create and manage milestones within a contract and fund them securely	
So that	the designer knows exactly what to deliver and I control payment release	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Contract creation: add milestones (title, description, amount, due date) ✓ Fund Milestone button opens Razorpay checkout with prefilled amount ✓ Milestone status visible to both parties in real time ✓ Request Revision button available when designer submits deliverables ✓ Approve and Release button releases payment from escrow to designer ✓ Contract summary shows total value, paid, pending, and remaining	

US-023 Search and Discover Designers		P1
As a	client	
I want to	browse the designer marketplace and find talent proactively	
So that	I can hire designers directly without posting a job first	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Designer discovery page with search by name, skill, category, location ✓ Filter by: AI score range, hourly rate range, experience years, availability, tools ✓ Designer cards show: name, tagline, AI score, top skills, hourly rate, avg rating ✓ Click through to full public profile ✓ Direct Invite button — send job invitation to designer before posting publicly	

5.4 Admin Features

US-030 Access Admin Dashboard		P0
As a	admin	
I want to	access a protected dashboard with full platform oversight	
So that	I can manage all users, jobs, and contracts from one place	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Admin route accessible only to users with role=admin in DB ✓ Dashboard home shows live metrics: MAU, GMV, active contracts, open disputes ✓ Navigation to all modules: Users, Jobs, Contracts, Payments, Disputes, AI Reports, Settings ✓ All admin actions logged to an audit trail table ✓ Admin session requires TOTP 2FA	

US-031 Manage Disputes		P0
As a	admin	
I want to	review and resolve payment disputes between designers and clients	
So that	platform trust is maintained and funds are released fairly	
Acceptance Criteria	✓ Disputes queue shows all open disputes with age, parties, contract value ✓ Dispute detail shows: contract overview, milestone in question, full message history, evidence ✓ Resolution options: Release to Designer, Refund to Client, or Split (custom %) ✓ Admin leaves a resolution note (required before submitting) ✓ Both parties notified by email and in-app notification on resolution ✓ Disputed milestone cannot be released or refunded until admin resolves	

06

Feature Specifications

Detailed specs for every platform feature

6.1 Job Card — Required Fields

Field	Source	Display Rules
Job Title	jobs.title	Max 2 lines, truncate with ellipsis
Client Name + Logo	client_profiles	Show company name if set, else full name
Budget Range	jobs.budget_min / budget_max	Show as Rs X,000 – Rs Y,000. If hourly, show /hr
Category Tag	jobs.category	Colour-coded chip (Branding=blue, UI=purple, Motion=orange)
Time Posted	jobs.created_at	Show as '2 hours ago', '3 days ago'
Applications Count	jobs.applications_count	Show as '12 proposals'
Experience Level	jobs.experience_level	Badge: Junior, Mid, or Senior
Save/Bookmark	saved_jobs table	Heart icon, toggles saved state

6.2 Marketplace Filters

Filter	Type	Options / Range
Search	Text input (full-text)	Searches title and description
Category	Multi-select chips	Branding, UI/UX, Motion, Illustration, Print, Web, Social Media
Budget	Range slider	Rs 0 – Rs 5L+
Experience Level	Multi-select	Junior, Mid-Level, Senior
Project Duration	Dropdown	Less than 1 week, 1–4 weeks, 1–3 months, Ongoing
Budget Type	Toggle	Fixed Price or Hourly
Posted Within	Dropdown	Last 24h, 3 days, 1 week, 1 month

6.3 Designer Public Profile Sections

Section	Contents	Visibility
Header	Avatar, name, tagline, location, availability badge, AI score	Public
About	Bio paragraph, years of experience, hourly rate	Public

Skills & Tools	Skill chips, tool chips	Public
Portfolio	Grid of portfolio items (thumbnail, title, category)	Public
Portfolio Item Detail	Full images, description, tools used, case study link	Public
AI Score Panel	Overall score, dimension breakdown (4 bars)	Public
Work History	Completed contracts with client name and review	Public
Reviews	All client reviews with star rating and written feedback	Public
Stats	Total projects, total earnings (masked), response rate	Public
Links	LinkedIn, Behance, Dribbble, personal site	Public

6.4 Notification Event Matrix

Event	Who Gets Notified	Channels
New application on job	Client	In-app and email
Application status changed	Designer	In-app and email
Hired (contract created)	Both	In-app and email
Milestone funded	Designer	In-app and email
Deliverables submitted	Client	In-app and email
Milestone approved and paid	Designer	In-app and email
Revision requested	Designer	In-app and email
New message	Recipient	In-app and email (batched hourly)
Dispute raised	Both and Admin	In-app and email
Dispute resolved	Both	In-app and email
Portfolio analysis ready	Designer	In-app and email

07

AI Feature Specifications

Portfolio analysis and skill development deep-spec

7.1 AI Portfolio Analysis — Full Specification

Input Requirements

Input Type	Accepted Formats	Constraints
Portfolio Images	JPG, PNG, WebP	Min 1, max 10 images per analysis. Max 5MB per image.
PDF Portfolio	PDF	Max 20MB. Pages extracted as images server-side.
Portfolio URL	Behance, Dribbble (Phase 2)	Screenshots taken server-side via Puppeteer.

Analysis Dimensions and Scoring

Dimension	Weight	What AI Evaluates
Visual Quality & Aesthetics	25%	Composition balance, typography hierarchy and pairing, colour intentionality, pixel polish, visual consistency, distinctive point-of-view
Skill Range & Tool Diversity	20%	Breadth of work types shown, tools inferred from visual style, specialist vs generalist signal, missing skill categories
Project Depth & Case Study Quality	30%	Evidence of process (wireframes, iterations, research), problem framing, outcome articulation, business context, team and timeline context
Market Fit & Client Relevance	25%	Alignment with current platform demand, niche strength identification, positioning clarity for potential clients, hireable verticals

Report Output Structure

Report Section	Content	Length
Header	Designer name, analysis date, overall AI score (0–100)	1 line
Overview	Senior-level read on the portfolio, strengths and character	3–4 sentences
Visual Quality & Aesthetics	Specific observations, named strengths, specific watch-outs	4–6 sentences
Skill Range & Tool Diversity	What is demonstrated, implied, and missing	4–6 sentences
Project Depth & Case Study Quality	Honest assessment specific to submitted work	4–6 sentences
Market Fit & Client Relevance	Strong fit niches, missing demand areas, positioning read	4–6 sentences
Recommended Next Steps	3–5 concrete, prioritised actions specific to this portfolio	3–5 bullets

AI Score Justification	Brief rationale for the overall score	2–3 sentences
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Usage Limits and Gating

Plan	Analyses per Month	Gating Behaviour
Free (Designer)	3	Counter shown in dashboard. On 4th attempt: paywall for Pro upgrade.
Pro (Rs 499/month)	Unlimited	No counter. Instant analysis.
Admin	Unlimited	For QA and quality auditing.

7.2 AI Skill Development Roadmap

Roadmap Output Structure

Section	Content
Top 3 Priority Skills	Named skills with reasoning tied to portfolio gaps and market demand
Learning Resources (per skill)	Specific free resources (YouTube, articles, tools) and paid courses
Week 1–4 Milestones	Concrete weekly learning goals — what to study and produce each week
Week 5–8 Milestones	Intermediate deliverables — specific projects to build
Week 9–12 Milestones	Portfolio-ready work — what to add to portfolio by end of 90 days
Earnings Potential Impact	Expected change in hireable rate after completing the roadmap
Progress Tracking	Designer can tick off milestones — completion % tracked in dashboard

08

Payment & Commission Specifications

Payment flow, escrow rules, subscription logic, payout

8.1 Commission and Pricing Structure

Revenue Stream	Amount	Notes
Platform Commission	10% of project value	Deducted before payout. Applies to all contract payments.
Designer Free Plan	Rs 0/month	3 AI analyses/month, max 10 active applications
Designer Pro Plan	Rs 499/month	Unlimited AI, priority listing, analytics dashboard
Client Free Plan	Rs 0/month	Up to 3 active job postings
Client Growth Plan	Rs 1,499/month	Unlimited jobs, featured placement, AI talent recommendations

8.2 Payment State Machine

State	Description	Triggered By
created	Razorpay order created, awaiting payment	Client clicks Fund Milestone
pending	Payment initiated in Razorpay checkout	User enters card or UPI details
captured	Payment confirmed by Razorpay webhook	Razorpay payment.captured event
failed	Payment attempt failed	Razorpay payment.failed event
escrowed	Funds held by platform pending delivery	Automatic after captured
released	Funds transferred to designer (minus 10%)	Client approves milestone
refunded	Funds returned to client	Admin dispute resolution or client cancels early
disputed	Funds frozen pending admin review	Either party raises dispute

8.3 Escrow Rules

- Client funds a milestone via Razorpay — funds are captured and held by the platform
- Designer does NOT receive payment at this stage — milestone status becomes 'funded'
- Designer submits deliverables — milestone status becomes 'submitted'
- Client has 5 business days to approve or request revision
- If client takes no action within 5 days: milestone auto-approves and payout is released
- Once approved: platform initiates payout within 24 hours via Razorpay Payouts
- Designer receives 90% of milestone amount; platform retains 10% commission
- If client raises dispute: funds frozen immediately, admin resolves within 48 hours
- Full refund only available if designer has not submitted any deliverables
- Partial refund (custom split) at admin discretion for disputed milestones

8.4 Invoice and Tax Requirements

Requirement	Implementation
Invoice generation	Auto-generated PDF for each milestone payment
GST handling	Platform charges 18% GST on subscription fees
TDS compliance	Designers earning above Rs 30,000/year flagged for TDS (194J — 10%)
Download	Designer and client can download invoice PDF from payment history
Invoice format	Talent Thread letterhead, sequential invoice number, GST-compliant fields

09

Non-Functional Requirements

Performance, security, accessibility, scalability

9.1 Performance Requirements

Metric	Target	Measurement
First Contentful Paint (FCP)	< 1.5 seconds	Vercel Analytics and Lighthouse
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP)	< 2.5 seconds	Core Web Vitals in Vercel
Time to Interactive (TTI)	< 3.5 seconds	Lighthouse audit
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS)	< 0.1	Core Web Vitals
API response time (p95)	< 500ms for read queries	Vercel function logs
AI analysis API response	< 30 seconds end-to-end	Server-side timer with loading state
Marketplace page load (50 jobs)	< 2 seconds	Manual and Lighthouse
Concurrent users at launch	Handle 500 concurrent users	Load test before launch

9.2 Security Requirements

Authentication

- JWT sessions managed by Supabase Auth with refresh token rotation
- Passwords hashed with bcrypt — never stored plaintext
- Email verification required before any platform access
- Admin accounts require TOTP 2FA
- Brute-force protection: 5 failed logins triggers 15-minute logout

API Security

- All mutation endpoints require authenticated session (server-side check)
- Zod schema validation on every API route — reject unexpected fields
- Rate limiting on AI routes: 10 requests per hour per user
- Rate limiting on auth routes: 5 attempts per minute per IP
- HTTPS only — HTTP redirects to HTTPS (enforced by Vercel)

Data Protection

- Bank account details stored AES-256 encrypted — never in plaintext
- Razorpay payment data never touches our DB — only order ID and verification hash
- Supabase RLS enforced on every table — tested per role before launch
- SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY accessible only in server-side code, never client

Payments Security

- All payment amounts validated server-side — client-sent amounts are never trusted

- Razorpay signature verified cryptographically before updating any payment status
- Webhook endpoints protected with shared secret header validation
- Duplicate webhook delivery idempotency: check payment status before updating

9.3 Accessibility Requirements

Standard	Requirement
WCAG Level	AA compliance for all public-facing pages
Colour Contrast	Minimum 4.5:1 ratio for body text; 3:1 for large text
Keyboard Navigation	All interactive elements reachable and operable via keyboard
Screen Reader	All images have alt text; form inputs have associated labels
Focus Indicators	Visible focus ring on all interactive elements
Error Messages	Form errors associated with their input via aria-describedby
Skip Navigation	Skip to main content link on all pages
Motion	Respect prefers-reduced-motion media query

9.4 Scalability Requirements

Concern	Approach
Database	Supabase Postgres with connection pooling (PgBouncer). Indexes on all FK columns and search fields.
File storage	Supabase Storage (S3-backed). No storage bottleneck at MVP scale.
AI API costs	Rate limiting and caching — same portfolio images never re-analysed. Estimated Rs 4–8 per analysis.
Serverless functions	Vercel Edge Functions for low-latency routes. No always-on server to maintain.
Real-time messaging	Supabase Realtime (WebSocket). Scales to ~50K concurrent connections on Pro plan.
Future scale	If over 10K MAU: migrate to dedicated Supabase project on higher tier plus Redis for caching.

10

Information Architecture

Sitemap, navigation structure, URL schema

10.1 Full Sitemap

URL	Page Name	Access	Role
/	Landing / Home	Public	All
/login	Login	Public	All
/register	Register	Public	All
/onboarding	Onboarding Flow	Auth Required	All
/marketplace	Job Listings	Public	All
/marketplace/[job-id]	Job Detail	Public	All
/designers	Designer Discovery	Public	Client
/designers/[username]	Designer Public Profile	Public	All
/designer/dashboard	Designer Home	Auth	Designer
/designer/applications	My Applications	Auth	Designer
/designer/contracts	My Contracts	Auth	Designer
/designer/contracts/[id]	Contract Detail and Chat	Auth	Designer
/designer/portfolio	Manage Portfolio	Auth	Designer
/designer/ai-analysis	AI Portfolio Analysis	Auth	Designer
/designer/skill-roadmap	Skill Development Roadmap	Auth	Designer
/designer/earnings	Earnings and Payouts	Auth	Designer
/designer/settings	Account Settings	Auth	Designer
/client/dashboard	Client Home	Auth	Client
/client/post-job	Post a Job	Auth	Client
/client/jobs	My Jobs	Auth	Client
/client/jobs/[id]/applications	Review Applications	Auth	Client
/client/contracts	My Contracts	Auth	Client
/client/contracts/[id]	Contract Detail and Chat	Auth	Client

/admin	Admin Dashboard Home	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/users	User Management	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/jobs	Job Management	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/contracts	Contract Management	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/disputes	Dispute Resolution	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/payments	Payment Management	Admin Only	Admin
/admin/settings	Platform Settings	Admin Only	Admin

11

UX Requirements & Design Principles

Interaction patterns, component standards

11.1 Design Principles

Clarity over cleverness

Every screen should be immediately understandable without explanation. If a designer needs to figure out what to do, the design has failed.

Trust through transparency

Show payment status, contract status, and application status at every step. Hidden states erode trust. Every status change is surfaced immediately.

AI is a tool, not a gimmick

AI features exist to deliver genuine value — not to appear tech-forward. The portfolio report should feel like it came from a real creative director.

Design-native aesthetic

The platform itself should be beautifully designed. A platform for designers should look like it was made by one.

Speed of action

Any key action — apply, post, fund, approve — should require minimal steps. Apply to a job in under 3 minutes. Fund a milestone in under 2 minutes.

11.2 Component Standards

Component	Standard
Buttons	Primary (navy fill), Secondary (outline), Destructive (red). Minimum 44px touch target.
Forms	Label above input, helper text below, error state in red, inline validation on blur
Status badges	Colour-coded chips: green=active/approved, amber=pending, red=rejected, grey=inactive
Cards	Subtle shadow, 8px border-radius, hover state elevation
Modals	Slide-over panel for quick actions. Full modal for confirmations. Never nested.
Empty states	Illustrated empty state with clear CTA. Never a blank page.
Loading states	Skeleton screens for data-fetching. Spinner only for actions (submitting, uploading).
Toast notifications	Top-right position, 4-second auto-dismiss, success/error/info variants

11.3 Responsive Breakpoints

Breakpoint	Width	Layout Behaviour
Mobile	< 640px	Single column. Marketplace as stacked cards. Bottom nav. Full-screen panels.

Tablet	640px – 1024px	2-column marketplace grid. Sidebar collapses to icon rail.
Desktop	> 1024px	3-column marketplace grid. Full sidebar navigation. Split-view for contract detail.

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Integrations & APIs

All third-party services and their integration contracts

12.1 Integration Map

Service	Purpose	Integration Method	SLA and Fallback
Supabase	Database, Auth, Storage, Realtime	supabase-js SDK	99.9% uptime SLA. Fallback: retry with exponential backoff.
Anthropic Claude API	Portfolio analysis, skill roadmap generation	@anthropic-ai/sdk POST /v1/messages	Retry 3x on failure. Show Analysis unavailable gracefully.
Razorpay	Payment collection, verification, payouts	razorpay Node SDK and webhooks	99.99% SLA. On failure: order stays pending, retry webhook or manual resolution.
Resend	Transactional email	resend SDK POST /emails	3,000/mo free. On failure: log to DB queue, retry hourly.
Vercel	Hosting, serverless, CDN, analytics	Git push to deploy	99.99% SLA. Edge caching for static assets.
Sentry	Error monitoring	@sentry/nextjs SDK	No dependency — app functions without it.

12.2 Webhook Contracts

Source	Event	Our Endpoint	Action Taken
Razorpay	payment.captured	/api/payments/webhook	Update payment to captured, milestone to funded
Razorpay	payment.failed	/api/payments/webhook	Update payment to failed, notify client
Razorpay	payout.processed	/api/payments/webhook	Update payout record, notify designer
Razorpay	payout.failed	/api/payments/webhook	Alert admin, retry payout next day
Supabase	DB insert (messages)	Supabase Realtime channel	Push to client via WebSocket

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Out of Scope — v1.0

Explicit boundaries for the initial release

The following features are explicitly excluded from v1.0 to maintain focus and ship on time.

Feature	Rationale for Exclusion	Target Version
Mobile App (iOS/Android)	Web-first PWA is sufficient for MVP. Native app adds 3+ months.	v2.0
Video portfolio support	Storage and encoding costs. Not needed for launch.	v2.0
Behance/Dribbble URL scraping	Puppeteer complexity. Image upload covers 90% of use cases.	v2.0
Team/agency accounts	Single-user freelancer model is simpler for trust and payment flow.	v2.0
Multi-currency (non-INR)	Razorpay INR-first. International expansion is post-seed.	v3.0
Razorpay Subscriptions	Manual subscription management for launch. Auto-billing added post-PMF.	v1.5
AI job matching	Requires enough data to be meaningful. Post-launch.	v2.0
Public API for third parties	No demand validated for this yet.	v3.0
Video interviews in-platform	Third-party video via chat links is sufficient.	v3.0
Crypto payments	No validated demand. Regulatory complexity in India.	Not planned
Multi-language support	English-first for professional design audience.	v2.0
AI-generated design briefs	Interesting but non-core. Adds scope without validating core hypothesis.	v2.5

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Risks & Mitigations

Platform, technical, and market risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Chicken-and-egg problem (no designers then no clients then no designers)	High	High	Seed 200+ designers via Discord community before opening to clients. Offer free Pro plan for first 100 designers.
Anthropic API cost overrun (AI analysis too expensive at scale)	Medium	Medium	Cap at 3 analyses/month free. Cache all reports. Estimated Rs 4–8 per analysis — Pro subscription covers ~60+ analyses.
Razorpay KYC delay (payment go-live blocked by verification)	Medium	High	Start Razorpay KYC in Month 1 of build. Build payments with test keys, switch to live keys when approved.
Low designer activation (sign up but do not complete onboarding)	Medium	High	Email drip sequence over 7 days. AI analysis as the activation hook.
Portfolio analysis quality not meeting expectations	Medium	High	Run 50 internal test analyses before launch. Collect NPS on every report. Iterate prompt weekly.
Payment disputes overwhelming admin capacity	Low	High	Clear escrow rules in T&C.; 5-day auto-approval reduces disputes. Hire part-time moderator when disputes exceed 10/month.
Competitor launches design-specific platform	Low	Medium	AI depth and India-first positioning is defensible. Focus on community and brand before any competitor can establish trust.

15

Appendix

Glossary, priority matrix, revision log

15.1 Glossary

Term	Definition
GMV	Gross Merchandise Value — total value of all transactions before fee deductions
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue — predictable subscription revenue per month
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost — total marketing spend divided by new customers acquired
LTV	Lifetime Value — estimated total revenue from a customer over their relationship with platform
AI Score	A 0–100 score assigned to a designer's portfolio by the portfolio analysis AI
Milestone	A deliverable-linked payment unit within a contract
Escrow	Funds held by the platform between client payment and designer payout
RLS	Row Level Security — Supabase/Postgres feature restricting data access per user at DB layer
P0 / P1 / P2 / P3	Priority tiers: P0 = launch blocker, P1 = high, P2 = medium, P3 = backlog
Activation	The point at which a new user completes onboarding and performs their first key action
Commission	The 10% platform fee deducted from every milestone payment before designer payout
Payout	The transfer of funds from platform escrow to a designer's bank account via Razorpay
Direct Invite	A Pro feature allowing clients to send job invitations directly to specific designers
NPS	Net Promoter Score — measure of user satisfaction and likelihood to recommend the platform

15.2 Priority Matrix

Priority	Meaning	Criteria
P0	Launch Blocker	Platform cannot launch without this feature
P1	High Priority	Major value driver, ships in first 3 months post-launch
P2	Medium Priority	Valuable but not blocking — Phase 4–5 of build
P3	Nice to Have	Backlog — evaluate based on user feedback post-launch

15.3 Revision Log

Version	Date	Author	Changes
0.1	January 2026	Pranay Pawar	Initial draft — platform vision and persona research
0.5	February 2026	Pranay Pawar	Added AI feature specs, payment flows, user stories
1.0	March 2026	Pranay Pawar	Full PRD — all sections complete, ready for engineering handoff

This PRD is the single source of truth for all product decisions on Talent Thread v1.0. Any feature not in this document is out of scope for the initial build. Changes require Product Owner sign-off and a version bump in the revision log.

— *Pranay Pawar, Product Owner — March 2026*